

C200

# Managing Organizations and Leading People

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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# How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | _____  |                               |

# Items

1.

A regional operations manager at a 400-employee distribution company, who joined from a competitor last spring, spends Monday comparing last month's on-time shipping rate of 91% with the 95% target. She then orders a change in how trucks are loaded to close the gap. Which management function is she mainly performing?

- A. Controlling.
- B. Planning, because the 95% target is part of a plan.
- C. Organizing, because she rearranges how trucks are loaded.
- D. All four functions equally, since every manager does all of them.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager is performing the organizing function. Which activity is she doing?

- A. Setting next year's sales targets.
- B. Coaching an employee whose morale has dropped.
- C. Grouping jobs into teams and deciding who reports to whom.
- D. Reviewing monthly spending against the budget.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

3.

A plant manager at a family-owned food processor, which has won two state safety awards, is pulled from a budget meeting when two shift supervisors refuse to share a forklift and the line stops. She settles the dispute on the spot and restarts the line. Which of Mintzberg's roles is she playing?

- A. Resource allocator, because she was in a budget meeting.
- B. Figurehead, because the plant is known for its safety awards.
- C. Leader, an interpersonal role.
- D. Disturbance handler, a decisional role.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

4.

A newly promoted senior vice president at a five-hospital system, who earned her MBA ten years ago and started as a staff nurse, now spends most of her week on how the hospitals fit together and where regional health care is heading. According to Katz, which skill matters most at her level?

- A. Technical skill, because she started as a nurse.
- B. Human skill, which matters more at the top than anywhere else.
- C. Conceptual skill.
- D. Only conceptual skill; human and technical skills no longer apply.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Compared with a top executive, which skill is relatively more important for a first-line supervisor?

- A. Strategic planning skill.
- B. Technical skill.
- C. Human skill.
- D. Conceptual skill.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

6.

A senior analyst at a mid-size insurer has run the quarterly forecast without errors for four years. She is confident, asks for more ownership, and recently moved to a hybrid schedule with two office days a week. Under Hersey and Blanchard's situational leadership model, which style should her manager use for the forecast?

- A. Telling.
- B. Participating, because hybrid staff need more check-ins.
- C. Delegating.
- D. Selling.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**7.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A leader uses a telling (directing) style. Which follower does this style fit best?

- A.** Someone new to the task who lacks the skill and is unsure of themselves.
- B.** Every new employee, regardless of prior experience.
- C.** An experienced expert who is confident and motivated.
- D.** A skilled employee who has lost confidence after a setback.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**8.**

A call-center director who manages a \$3 million budget offers a \$200 bonus to every agent who keeps average handle time under 90 seconds. Agents who miss the target are assigned extra review sessions. The center opened two years ago in a converted warehouse. Which leadership approach is the director using?

- A.** Laissez-faire leadership.
- B.** Transactional leadership.
- C.** Transformational leadership, because the bonus motivates agents.
- D.** Servant leadership, because agents get extra sessions.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**9.**

A project manager at an engineering firm, who holds a professional license and has fifteen years of experience, has learned that she turns curt in meetings when she is short on sleep. Now, when she feels that irritation, she pauses and waits until she is calm before giving feedback. In Goleman's model, which component does the pausing show?

- A.** Technical expertise, shown by her license.
- B.** Self-awareness.
- C.** Empathy.
- D.** Self-regulation.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**10.**

In a 360-degree review, all of a department head's peers say he interrupts people in meetings, which he had never noticed. He runs a 60-person department and has met his budget five years in a row. In the Johari window, which area did this feedback shrink?

- A.** The open area.
- B.** The blind area.
- C.** The unknown area.
- D.** The hidden area.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**11.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager wants to shrink her hidden area in the Johari window. What should she do?

- A.** Never share personal information at work.
- B.** Ask her team for honest feedback on her behavior.
- C.** Take a personality assessment and keep the results private.
- D.** Share more of her views, concerns and working preferences with her team.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**12.**

A retail district manager who oversees eleven stores, and who just completed a leadership course, is helping a store manager write a goal for next quarter. The store's customer satisfaction score is 82. Which goal meets the SMART criteria?

- A.** Raise the store's customer satisfaction score from 82 to 88 by June 30.
- B.** Hold a service huddle every Monday.
- C.** Reach a perfect score of 100 by next week.
- D.** Greatly improve customer service this year.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer A Concept 1

A regional operations manager ~~at a 400-employee distribution company, who joined from a competitor last spring,~~ spends Monday comparing last month's on-time shipping rate of 91% with the 95% target. She then orders a change in how trucks are loaded to close the gap. Which management function is she mainly performing?

**Target word:** which function **Decides:** Comparing actual results to a standard and correcting the gap.

|   |                   |                                                                                                              |
|---|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>    | Measuring performance, comparing it to a standard, and taking corrective action is the controlling function. |
| B | Adjacent category | The target was set earlier by planning; using it to check and correct results is controlling.                |
| C | Confusion set     | The loading change is the corrective action inside the control cycle, not a redesign of structure.           |
| D | Absolute language | Managers do all four over time, but this activity is mainly one of them.                                     |

## 2. Answer C Concept 1 · transfer

A manager is performing the organizing function. Which activity is she doing?

**Target word:** activity that fits organizing **Decides:** Organizing = arranging tasks, people and reporting lines.

|   |                    |                                                                                             |
|---|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Adjacent category  | Setting goals is planning.                                                                  |
| B | Confusion set      | Influencing and motivating people is leading.                                               |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | Designing structure and assigning work is organizing.                                       |
| D | Inverted operation | Checking results after the fact is controlling, the end of the cycle rather than the setup. |

## 3. Answer D Concept 2

A plant manager at a family-owned food processor, ~~which has won two state safety awards,~~ is pulled from a ~~budget meeting~~ when two shift supervisors refuse to share a forklift and the line stops. She settles the dispute on the spot and restarts the line. Which of Mintzberg's roles is she playing?

**Target word:** which Mintzberg role **Decides:** An unplanned conflict that the manager must resolve.

|   |                   |                                                                                                             |
|---|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Confusion set     | Resource allocation is planned distribution of resources; the budget meeting is not what she is doing here. |
| B | Camouflage        | Answers the awards detail; figurehead is ceremonial duty.                                                   |
| C | Adjacent category | The leader role covers motivating and directing staff in general, not resolving a sudden breakdown.         |
| D | <b>Correct</b>    | Responding to unexpected conflicts and crises is the disturbance handler role.                              |

#### 4. Answer C Concept 3

A newly promoted senior vice president at a five-hospital system, ~~who earned her MBA ten years ago and started as a staff nurse~~, now spends most of her week on how the hospitals fit together and where regional health care is heading. According to Katz, which skill matters most at her level?

**Target word:** most important skill at the top **Decides:** She is a top-level manager working on the whole system.

|          |                   |                                                                                              |
|----------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Camouflage        | Her nursing background does not change what her current level requires.                      |
| B        | Adjacent category | Human skill matters at every level about equally; it is not the one that peaks at the top.   |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Seeing the organization as a whole and its place in the environment matters most at the top. |
| D        | Absolute language | Other skills still matter; conceptual skill is simply the most important at this level.      |

#### 5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

Compared with a top executive, which skill is relatively more important for a first-line supervisor?

**Target word:** skill that peaks at the lowest level **Decides:** First-line supervisors work closest to the hands-on work.

|          |                    |                                                                              |
|----------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set      | Strategic planning is a top-level, conceptual activity.                      |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Knowing how the work is done matters most for those supervising it directly. |
| C        | Adjacent category  | Human skill is about equally important at every level.                       |
| D        | Inverted operation | Conceptual skill grows in importance toward the top, not the bottom.         |

#### 6. Answer C Concept 4

A senior analyst ~~at a mid-size insurer~~ has run the quarterly forecast without errors for four years. She is confident, asks for more ownership, ~~and recently moved to a hybrid schedule with two office days a week~~. Under Hersey and Blanchard's situational leadership model, which style should her manager use for the forecast?

**Target word:** which style for this follower **Decides:** High ability and high willingness on this task.

|          |                    |                                                                                   |
|----------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Inverted operation | Telling fits the opposite follower: low ability and low confidence.               |
| B        | Camouflage         | The work schedule does not decide the style; readiness on the task does.          |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | A follower who is both able and willing needs little direction or support.        |
| D        | Adjacent category  | Selling fits someone still building ability who needs both direction and support. |

#### 7. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A leader uses a telling (directing) style. Which follower does this style fit best?

**Target word:** follower who fits telling **Decides:** Telling = high direction for low readiness.

|          |                    |                                                                                |
|----------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Low ability and low confidence call for clear, specific direction.             |
| B        | Absolute language  | Readiness is task-specific; an experienced new hire may need little direction. |
| C        | Inverted operation | That follower fits delegating.                                                 |
| D        | Adjacent category  | High ability with low confidence fits participating (supporting).              |

## 8. Answer B Concept 5

A call-center director ~~who manages a \$3 million budget~~ offers a \$200 bonus to every agent who keeps average handle time under 90 seconds. Agents who miss the target are assigned extra review sessions. ~~The center opened two years ago in a converted warehouse.~~ Which leadership approach is the director using?

**Target word:** leadership approach **Decides:** Rewards and corrections exchanged for meeting a set standard.

|          |                   |                                                                                                      |
|----------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category | Laissez-faire is hands-off; this director sets targets and acts on results.                          |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Contingent rewards and corrective action tied to targets are the core of transactional leadership.   |
| C        | Confusion set     | Motivation alone is not transformational; that style inspires through vision, not a reward exchange. |
| D        | Dropped element   | Ignores that the sessions are a correction for missing the target, part of the exchange.             |

## 9. Answer D Concept 6

A project manager at an engineering firm, ~~who holds a professional license and has fifteen years of experience,~~ has learned that she turns curt in meetings when she is short on sleep. Now, when she feels that irritation, she pauses and waits until she is calm before giving feedback. In Goleman's model, which component does the pausing show?

**Target word:** EI component shown by pausing **Decides:** She is managing an emotion she already recognizes.

|          |                   |                                                                                  |
|----------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Camouflage        | Her credentials are not part of emotional intelligence.                          |
| B        | Adjacent category | Recognizing the pattern was self-awareness; the pause is what she does about it. |
| C        | Confusion set     | Empathy is reading others' emotions, not managing her own.                       |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Controlling impulses and choosing a calm response is self-regulation.            |

## 10. Answer B Concept 7

In a 360-degree review, all of a department head's peers say he interrupts people in meetings, which he had never noticed. ~~He runs a 60 person department and has met his budget five years in a row.~~ In the Johari window, which area did this feedback shrink?

**Target word:** which area shrank **Decides:** Others knew something he did not; feedback told him.

|          |                    |                                                                                            |
|----------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Inverted operation | Feedback grows the open area; it does not shrink it.                                       |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Known to others but not to self; feedback moves it into the open area.                     |
| C        | Adjacent category  | The unknown area is unknown to both him and others; his peers already knew this.           |
| D        | Confusion set      | The hidden area holds what he knows but others do not; it shrinks through self-disclosure. |

## 11. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

A manager wants to shrink her hidden area in the Johari window. What should she do?

**Target word:** action that shrinks the hidden area **Decides:** Hidden = known to self, not to others.

|          |                   |                                                                             |
|----------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Absolute language | That keeps the hidden area as large as it is.                               |
| B        | Confusion set     | Asking for feedback shrinks the blind area.                                 |
| C        | Dropped element   | She may learn about herself, but without sharing, others still do not know. |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Self-disclosure moves what only she knows into the open area.               |

## 12. Answer A Concept 8

A retail district manager ~~who oversees eleven stores, and who just completed a leadership course,~~ is helping a store manager write a goal for next quarter. The store's customer satisfaction score is 82. Which goal meets the SMART criteria?

**Target word:** the SMART goal **Decides:** Only one option is specific, measurable, realistic and has a deadline.

|   |                   |                                                                           |
|---|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Correct           | Specific measure, realistic change, relevant to the store and time-bound. |
| B | Adjacent category | An activity, not an outcome goal.                                         |
| C | Absolute language | Measurable and timed but not achievable.                                  |
| D | Dropped element   | No measure and no specific target.                                        |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | Right                                                 | Wrong                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| Trap               | What it does                                                 | In this drill | Your misses |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 3             |             |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 0             |             |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 11            |             |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 5             |             |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 5             |             |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 8             |             |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 4             |             |

# Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                                              | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Trap                                                                             | Tell                                                                      |
|---|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>The four functions of management</b>              | Planning sets goals, organizing arranges people and resources, leading influences people, and controlling compares results to standards and corrects.                                                    | Calling any action that follows a goal “planning,” or any order given “leading.” | A comparison of actual results against a target, followed by a fix.       |
| 2 | <b>Mintzberg's managerial roles</b>                  | Managers play interpersonal (figurehead, leader, liaison), informational (monitor, disseminator, spokesperson) and decisional (entrepreneur, disturbance handler, resource allocator, negotiator) roles. | Labeling every people-related task as the leader role.                           | An unplanned conflict or crisis the manager must settle.                  |
| 3 | <b>Katz's skills by management level</b>             | Technical skills matter most at lower levels, conceptual skills matter most at the top, and human skills matter at every level.                                                                          | Assuming the skill that got someone promoted stays the most important one.       | The manager's level and whether the work is hands-on or big-picture.      |
| 4 | <b>Situational leadership</b>                        | Match the style to follower readiness: telling for low ability and low confidence, selling, participating, and delegating for high ability and high willingness.                                         | Using one favorite style for every follower.                                     | A description of the follower's skill and willingness on a specific task. |
| 5 | <b>Transactional vs. transformational leadership</b> | Transactional leaders exchange rewards and corrections for meeting standards; transformational leaders inspire people toward a shared vision beyond self-interest.                                       | Calling any leader who motivates people transformational.                        | An explicit if-you-do-it his-you-get-that exchange.                       |
| 6 | <b>Emotional intelligence components</b>             | Self-awareness is noticing your own emotions; self-regulation is managing them; motivation, empathy and social skill complete Goleman's model.                                                           | Treating noticing an emotion and controlling it as the same skill.               | A person doing something about an emotion they already recognize.         |
| 7 | <b>The Johari window</b>                             | Feedback from others shrinks the blind area; self-disclosure shrinks the hidden area; both enlarge the open area.                                                                                        | Mixing up which action shrinks the blind area and which shrinks the hidden area. | Who learns something new: the person, or the others.                      |
| 8 | <b>SMART goals</b>                                   | A usable goal is specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound.                                                                                                                              | Accepting an activity or an aspiration as a goal.                                | A list of candidate goal statements with different levels of detail.      |

**Course scope (public description):** This course covers principles of effective management and leadership that maximize organizational performance. The following topics are included: the role and functions of a manager, analysis of personal leadership styles, approaches to self-awareness and self-assessment, and application of foundational leadership and management skills.